L-T-940B
November 12, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. L-T-940a
March 20, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TYPE CLEANER, PLASTIC RUBBER TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a plastic rubber base type cleaner, with cup, suitable for use in cleaning type of typewriters and similar office machines.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-121 - Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
DDD-R-311 - Ribbons, Typewriter.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

FSC 7510

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Type cleaner. The type cleaner shall be made of natural rubber, synthetic rubber, or a combination of the two, with other ingredients as necessary to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.1.2 Cup. The cup shall be made of a material suitable for the effective use of the type cleaner.

3.2 Performance.

3.2.1 Type cleaner. The type cleaner shall be soft and pliable enough not to damage the typewriter type. It shall remove ink and dirt from the typewriter keys without crumbling or leaving particles of the cleaner or coloring matter. The cleaner shall contain an ink holding agent to preclude soiling or discoloring the hands while kneading, and shall have no toxic fumes or objectionable odor.

3.2.1.1 Ductility. The type cleaner shall be capable of being drawn out to a length of 24 inches without breaking, when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.2.1.2 Type cleaning ability. The test paper shall be free from visible ink or dirt after performance of test specified in 4.3.2.

3.3 Construction of cup. The cup shall be pliable, of truncated cone shape. The wall thickness shall taper from the base to the open end and have at least two annular ribs spaced parallel from the open end along the inner wall. The ribs are to grip the type cleaner and control distortion of the cup. The cup shall have a handle issuing from the base, and shall be of suitable design to permit efficient application and use of the type cleaner.

3.4 Size.

3.4.1 Type cleaner. The type cleaner shall be not less than 1-1/8 cubic inches in volume and shall weigh not less than 1 ounce.

3.4.2 Cup. The cup shall be of suitable size to permit efficient application and use of the type cleaner.

3.5 Shelf life. The type cleaner, under normal storage conditions, shall retain its serviceability as defined by this specification for not less than 12 months from time of delivery. Suppliers shall make replacement, without cost to the Government, of all type cleaner failing to meet this requirement.

3.6 Identification marking. Each unit package shall be marked to clearly identify the product and its manufacturer by name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture can be readily determined.

3.7 Workmanship. The type cleaner shall be soft and pliable, and free from hard lumps. The cup shall be smoothly finished and free from imperfections or defects which might affect serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For the purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for acceptance, inspection, and tests shall consist of all type cleaner submitted for inspection and delivery at one time.

4.2.1 Sampling and examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For examination of contents, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate sealing.
	Bulging or distortion of container.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual examination of type cleaner. A random sample of type cleaner shall be taken from packages contained in each shipping container obtained in accordance with 4.2.1. The sample unit shall be on type cleaner unit. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level S-2.

4.2.3 Visual examination of type cleaner. Visual examinations of type cleaner shall be in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table II. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

TABLE II. Visual examination (end item)

Examine	Defects
Cup:	Missing.
Design	Not as specified.
Identification marking	Not as specified.
Use instructions	Not printed on unit package.
Volume	Less than specified.
Weight	Less than specified.

4.2.4 Sampling for tests on type cleaner. A random sample of 3 units of type cleaner shall be selected for the performance of the following tests: Failure to pass either test shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3 Tests. Samples shall be conditioned, and tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 73.4° ± 3.6°F., and at a relative humidity of 50 ± 5 percent.

4.3.1 Ductility test. An unused type cleaner shall be kneaded for three minutes and then rolled into a rod shap approximately 3-1/4 inch in diameter. Holding the specimen at midpoint with both hands pull apart at a uniform rate of approximately 12 inches per second. Evaluate for compliance with 3.2.1.1.

4.3.2 Type cleaning test. Install a new nylon typewriter ribbon conforming to the requirements for type I, of DDD-R-311 on an electric typewriter with elite type. Using one sample type cleaner, clean the type thoroughly as instructed on the sample package. Then with the typewriter impression indicator adjusted for single copy typing, type the small letters "a", "e", and "g" one hundred times each on a sheet of 32-pound white bond paper conforming to the requirements for type III of UU-P-121. Clean the "a", "e", and "g" keys using a second sample type cleaner as instructed on the package. With the ribbon color control in stencil position, type ten each of the small letters "a", "e", and "g" on another sheet of white bond paper as specified above. Inspect the paper for compliance with 3.2.1.2.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Each type cleaner unit shall be packaged in a solid sulphate paperboard box. The inside surfaces shall be coated with a 3/4 mil polyethylene coating.

5.1.1.1 Intermediate packaging. Twelve packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. The type cleaner shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve intermediate packages shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate packages shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The type cleaner shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in 5.1.1, 5.1.1.1 and 5.2.2.

5.4 Marking. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

5.5 Instruction for use. The instruction for use shall be printed on the sides of each unit package.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Data, as required, regarding examination and tests; and inspection responsibility for civil agency procurement if other than as specified (see 4.1).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

DOD coordination has been waived.

USER INTEREST	Preparing activity
Army - GL	GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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